Nicolas Eschenbaum

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Zürich, Switzerland

Economist and competition expert in industrial organization and competition policy, with a focus on algorithmic pricing, digital markets, and AI. I regularly prepare expert reports and provide economic analysis in competition cases and regulatory proceedings, and lead applied and academic research combining game theory, empirical methods, and machine learning.

Positions

2022–present **AI Lead and Managing Economist (Partner)**, Swiss Economics
Leading work on AI, digital markets, and competition policy in client and research projects. Member of the executive board.

2025–present **Member, Working Group AI/Algorithms**, Academic Society for Competition Law (ASCOLA)
Interdisciplinary work on the legal and policy implications of AI and algorithmic systems in competition law.

2022–present **Collaborator**, Institute for Categorical Cybernetics
Research collaboration on formal and computational approaches to governance, digital systems, and market design.

2024–present **Affiliated Researcher**, Zurich Center for Market Design, University of Zurich
Research on AI and agent-based models, with applications to energy markets.

2024–2025 **Global Fellow**, European AI & Society Fund
Research on foundation models and competition policy.

2018–2024 **Lecturer**, University of St. Gallen
Teaching in industrial organization, digitalization, and competition policy.

2018–2022 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, University of St. Gallen
Research on algorithmic pricing and competition in digital markets, funded by SNSF grant "Pricing in a Digital World."

Education

2013–2018 **Ph.D. in Economics and Finance**, University of St. Gallen
Summa cum laude. Dissertation: *Essays in Industrial Organization*. Supervisor: Prof. Stefan Bühler.

2011–2012 **M.Sc. in Economics**, University of Edinburgh
Graduated with honours.

2008–2011 **B.Sc. in Business and Economics**, Maastricht University

Research Visits

2020–2021 **Visiting Scholar**, Düsseldorf Institute for Competition Economics (DICE)
Invited by Prof. Justus Haucap.

Publications

Peer-reviewed articles

Picht PG, Nenadic L, Barnes O, **Eschenbaum N**, Kuster Y. "Selective Confusion: An Empirical Analysis of the DMA's Brussels Effect." *World Competition*, forthcoming. link

Greber N, **Eschenbaum N**, Szehr O. "Peer-to-Peer Electricity Platforms with Endogenous Prices: A Multi-Agent Neural Network Control Approach." *Energy and AI*, 2026.

Picht PG, Nenadic L, Barnes O, **Eschenbaum N**, Kuster Y. "DMA (Verw-)Irrungen: Was die territorialen Umsetzungsstrategien der Torwächter über den Digital Markets Act lehren." *Schweizerische Zeitschrift für Wirtschafts- und Finanzmarktrecht (SZW)*, no. 4, 2025. link

Picht PG, Nenadic L, Barnes O, **Eschenbaum N**, Kuster Y. "Schweizer DMA-Brussels-Effect? Wie Gatekeeper den DMA in der Schweiz (nicht) umsetzen." *sic! Zeitschrift für Immaterialgüter-, Informations- und Wettbewerbsrecht*, 3–14, 2024. link

Buehler S, **Eschenbaum N**. "Explaining Escalating Prices and Fines: A Unified Approach." *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, 171, 153–164, 2020. link

Working papers

Eschenbaum N, Meylahn JM. "Auditing Algorithmic Collusion from Strategy Graphs." 2026. link

Eschenbaum N. "Shared Bidding Algorithms and Competition: Evidence from Electricity Markets." 2026. link

Cheng TK, **Eschenbaum N**, Picht PG, Talluri K. "Algorithmic Pricing and Collusion in Practice." Working paper, 2026.

Eschenbaum N, Greber N. "Market Power and Platform Design in Decentralized Electricity Trading." 2026. link

Buehler S, **Eschenbaum N**, Lenhard S. "A Unified Framework for Dynamic Monopoly Pricing: Trading-Up." 2026. link

Buehler S, Epper T, **Eschenbaum N**, Koch R. "Dynamic Pricing in Bilateral Relationships: Experimental Evidence." Working paper, 2025.

Eschenbaum N, Greber N. "Repeated Auctions with Speculators: Arbitrage Incentives and Forks in DAOs." 2025. link

Eschenbaum N, Mellgren F, Zahn P. "Robust Algorithmic Collusion." 2022 (presented at the NeurIPS 2021 PERLS workshop). link

Eschenbaum N, Liebert H. "Dealing with Uncertainty: The Value of Reputation in the Absence of Legal Institutions." 2021. link

Eschenbaum N. "Estimating Geographic Market Size Nonparametrically: An Application to Grocery Retailing." Working paper, 2018.

Grants and Prizes

2024–2025 **The Market for Foundation Models**. European AI & Society Fund – CHF 50,000 (PI).

2024–2025 **DMA-effects in Switzerland**. Mercator Foundation – CHF 30,000 (co-PI).

2022–2025 **ChartEP: Charting Energy Platforms and Market Outcomes under Varying Policy Measures**. Swiss Federal Office of Energy – CHF 281,215 (PI).

2022 **Young Scholar Award**. CRESSE – CHF 1,500.

2021–2022 **Computational Learning in Economic Games**. Hasler Foundation – CHF 35,000 (co-PI).

2021–2022 **The Competitive Effects of Pricing Software Systems**. University of St. Gallen – CHF 51,555 (co-PI).

2018–2022 **Pricing in a Digital World**. Swiss National Science Foundation – CHF 500,000 (co-investigator), grant no. 178836.

Selected Applied and Policy Work

2026–present Study on modern pricing methods, pricing algorithms, and risks of collusion for the European Commission (DG COMP); leading the competition-economics analysis, in particular on third-party algorithmic pricing.

2025–present Regulatory impact assessment of intellectual property rules for AI systems, for the Swiss Federal Institute of Intellectual Property (IPI).

2022–present Expert reports and economic analysis for parties in proceedings before the Swiss Competition Commission (WEKO) involving information exchange and cartel allegations, including in the retail sector.

2023–2025 Lead economic analysis for a car-finance provider in WEKO cartel proceedings concerning interest rates.

2024–2025 Market definition and competitive assessment for a major digital platform.

2023 Consulted on pricing algorithms for the market-definition work in the review of a major cross-border merger.

2024–2025 Bidding and coordination analysis in secondary reserve power markets.

2024–2025 Assessment of reserve power requirements in Switzerland and neighbouring countries, for the Federal Electricity Commission (ElCom).

2023–2025 Market-power analysis for energy trading platforms using multi-agent deep reinforcement learning, ChartEP project for the Swiss Federal Office of Energy (SFOE).

2023–2024 Price-elasticity estimation in German wholesale and end-user energy markets, *Wirtschaftspolitik* Nr. 47, State Secretariat for Economic Affairs.

2023–2024 Incentive analysis and mechanism design for a Web3 platform.

2024 Game-theoretic and agent-based analysis of issuance-curve effects on staking behaviour.

Recent Talks and Presentations

2026 Talk, EURO Working Group on Revenue Management & Pricing workshop, Barcelona (December).

2026 Panellist, "The Next Wave of Tech Enforcement: Global Trends in Regulating Platforms and Algorithms," AIJA 13th Antitrust Annual Conference, Düsseldorf.

2026 "Market Power and Platform Design in Decentralized Electricity Trading," EARIE Annual Conference, Mannheim.

2026 "Algorithmic Pricing in Practice and Collusion," ASCOLA Annual Conference, London.

2026 Invited talk on the DMA's impact for Switzerland, State Secretariat for Economic Affairs (SECO), Bern.

2026 "Economic perspectives on market power in AI markets," ASCOLA Working Group on AI/Algorithms workshop.

2026 Invited guest lecture, course "Digitale Ökonomie" (Prof. R. Kesler), Düsseldorf Institute for Competition Economics (DICE).